

Reading on paper, again

A short field note

PagerPDF is a reader first. Pages stay in PDF points; pinch zoom is a view transform, so type stays sharp while you move. The desk is a single gray, and tiles refine under your fingers instead of flashing empty paper.

This paragraph is meant to be highlighted. Drag across the line and the mark is the markup itself ? yellow, not a blue selection overlay.

Search, outline, and thumbnails sit beside the page. Notes never rewrite the original file. They live in a sidecar until you choose to export.

Two pages, one glance

Spreads and continuous rows

Facing pages are a layout, not a second renderer. A ViewSpec names how many columns and rows to show, and whether an axis is continuous.

Single page replaces the sheet when you step next. Two-page continuous keeps every spread in one scroll. Horizontal scroll fits the row to the height of the window and lets you pan sideways.

Underline this sentence. A cover-alone option keeps page one on its own before pairing 2?3, 4?5, the way a bound book does.

Ink that stays put

Pen, marker, and erase

A pen stroke is a ribbon. Pressure, tilt, and speed feed a ballpoint that does not wobble when the pencil pauses. The marker is wide and translucent.

The eraser sweeps a capsule between samples so a fast swipe cannot skip the ink between recorded points. Cut ends stay square ? a partial erase does not grow pointed tips in the middle of a word.

Draw over this block. After you zoom, the stroke should still sit on the letters, because annotation tiles are independent of the PDF workers.

Shapes and text boxes

Insert without leaving the page

Rectangles, ovals, and lines are click-drag shapes. A text box is typed in place. Empty boxes do not linger in undo history.

Color and size chips are defined once in the shared palette, so the iPad dock and the Mac markup bar offer the same choices.

On iPad, fingers pan and markup. Apple Pencil is required for pen, marker, eraser, and insert. The simulator lets a finger stand in.

Look up, then search

Selection extras

Force-click a word on Mac to look it up. If you already selected a phrase, Look Up uses that phrase ? it does not collapse it to a PDFKit word. Holding the click does not reopen the dictionary.

Search with Google is on the context menu, the Edit menu, and the iPad edit menu. The query is exactly the current selection.

Control-Command-D does the same Look Up as a force click.

Sidecar notes

The PDF stays yours

Saves are a property list of annotations. Geometry is stored as number arrays so values round-trip at full double precision.

Write is debounced and off the main thread. The sidecar sits next to the PDF; a copy also lives in Application Support if the folder is read-only.

Export burns everything into a flattened PDF. Until then, the original bytes are left alone ? the way Skim keeps its notes.